Getting started

Siddharth M. Bhatia · siddharth@sidmb.com
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What fwd does

`fwd` moves a local coding project to remote compute. It provisions or connects to a target, synchronizes the project, prepares detected Python, JavaScript, or Swift tooling, and starts a persistent shell, command, Claude Code, or Codex session in tmux.

The remote session survives a dropped SSH connection or closed laptop. You can reconnect later, run durable background tasks, and pull results back to the local checkout.

Install

```
uv tool install fwdit
```

On the first `fwd` invocation, the bundled `fwd(1)` and command manuals are silently installed under the user-local XDG man directory, normally `~/.local/share/man/man1`. Later package upgrades update changed pages and remove obsolete fwd pages automatically, without `sudo` or a global post-install hook:

```
fwd --version
man fwd
man fwd-up
```

To try fwd without installing it:

```
uvx --from fwdit fwd --help
```

Local requirements are Python 3.12+, `ssh`, and `rsync`. Provider targets may require their own authentication or CLI; `fwd doctor` reports what is missing.

Launch a session

From a project directory:

```
fwd                         # attach to this project's session, or create
    one interactively
fwd up runpod codex         # launch Codex on a RunPod target without
    attaching
fwd up --target work        # launch the configured default command on
    target "work"
fwd up -- python train.py   # launch and stream a durable command
```

Bare `fwd` is the human-friendly reuse workflow. It attaches to an unambiguous session or creates one interactively. Scripts and coding agents should use explicit, non-attaching `fwd up` forms.

Detach from tmux with `Ctrl-B D`; the remote process continues running. Reconnect with:

```
fwd ls
fwd attach SESSION
```

Configure a target

You can use a direct SSH host, an OpenSSH alias, or built-in CPU RunPod defaults without saving a target:

```
fwd up --target user@example.com
fwd up --target my-ssh-alias
fwd up runpod
```

For reusable or provider-specific settings, run:

```
fwd targets add
```

`fwd targets add` (also spelled `fwd setup`) only writes configuration; it does not provision compute. Review saved targets with `fwd targets ls`, and edit one in place with `fwd targets update NAME`. See Configuration and backends for non-interactive setup and provider requirements.

Everyday workflow

```
fwd ls                    # inspect this project's sessions
fwd send -- pytest -q     # run durable work in the current remote
     session
fwd diff                  # compare synchronized local and remote files
fwd pull outputs/         # retrieve selected results without deleting
     local files
fwd stop                  # stop the session after the remote worktree
     is clean
fwd rm                    # permanently destroy its remote resources
```

Continue with Commands and lifecycle, or read Coding agents when moving a Claude Code or Codex workflow.

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